

THE MASS IMAGES OF JUDAISM AND CHRISTIANITY

QUESTION: I am very puzzled by the tremendously strong reactions about the whole issue of Jesus Christ. I understand what you said about the fear of expansion that applies to all phases of expansion. But this is so strong that I have the feeling there is more to it. Could you comment on this?

GUIDE: The next intended lecture would have amplified your question completely. Since you ask it now, I shall answer it and use this answer as the next lecture. In order to make the answer comprehensible, I shall start the lecture in a different way than it would have started otherwise, but that does not matter. The same message will be conveyed in it. We shall just build up from a different vantage point.

My beloved, most blessed friends! Many of you must feel the strength of divine blessings in your lives and in your tasks. This special joy, security, peace, and excitement, this deep sense that your life has profound meaning and purpose can only exist when your life is totally dedicated to God and His will and plan. The more this is the case, the more the clouds disappear and the fuller life becomes. This spirit of service encompasses more and more of my beloved friends and takes deeper roots in your hearts. This causes a great light to spring up from your level of consciousness and merge with the more powerful and purer light coming from our level of consciousness.

The strong reactions to the reality of Jesus Christ must be considered on two very specific and well defined levels: the personal and collective ones. Had this question not been asked, I would have started with the collective level -- that is, the mass image -- and would then have discussed the personal images, distortions, fears, and so on. Now I shall approach this issue the other way around.

Let us begin with the Christian who feels now a strong reaction against Jesus Christ, who has rebelled against his early upbringing and the values his parents stood for. Very often Jesus Christ is identified with rigid morality and a denial of feelings, of sexuality, of autonomy, of the strong energy that creates positive aggression and self-assertion. Christ is depicted as a meek, passive, sexless figure, who demands the same kind of distorted self-denial from all those who are to follow in His footsteps.

Thus a very confusing mixture in perception, understanding, and consciousness comes about. On the one hand, Christ is depicted as love, truth, wisdom, salvation, goodness, and service to the Creator and His plan. On the other hand, self-defeating denial of intrinsic human values, energies, and expressions go along with it. This is the mass image of Christianity!

As all mass images, so this too must stem from individuals with special conditions in early upbringing that foster the formation of images. This may have begun in this life or in previous lives.

The less a specific image has been dissolved, the more it creates conditions in the next incarnation that help recreate the image. It is then up to the individual to use these conditions in order to dissolve the image. These are repetitions of what I discussed years ago, pertaining to all images. In a little while we shall go through the mass image in detail from the point of view of images. Let me first return to the personal reactions of a child who grew up with this confusion and who deals with it in his or her own way.

The admixture of truth and falsehood about Jesus Christ is impossible for a child to disentangle. So he only has two choices. One alternative is that he submits to the totality of what is conveyed to him. In this case he will grow up into the traditional concept of what it is to be a Christian. He will fear his feelings, he will deny his sexuality, he will put reins on his aggression which is identified with evil. Underneath, all these impulses reign, but they are very threatening to him. He feels himself to be a sinner whenever he registers unallowed feelings. He also rebels, of course, but the fear of expressing this rebellion openly is much too strong. So it, too, must be repressed and denied, only to create more guilt, more a feeling of secretly being a sinner. This type of person will use any kind of doctrine to reinforce his denials. He will flock to orientations that take the Bible in a very literal and doctrinaire sense. He remains safe only in a rigid, life-denying structure.

The other alternative the child has is to openly and consciously rebel against these strictures of his very being. And this is of course the type of "rebellious Christian" we are concerned with on this path. For the "submitting Christian," the first category, would never enter such a path as this. It would be totally opposing the safety valves he has created.

The "rebellious Christian" image needs reinforcement for his rebellion, for underneath he carries with him some doubts about the justification of his rebellion. The truth is that he should deny the denial of his feelings, of his positive aggression, of his sexuality, of his self-responsibility and autonomy. But he certainly should not deny the truth of Jesus Christ in His love, His power, His presence, and the need to take Him into the individual's life.

The "submitting Christian" suffers from the same confusion and false fusion of truth and error. He would have to learn to do exactly the opposite of what the "rebellious Christian" does. All children need parents who are strong and right. This gives them a sense of security. A weak and "wrong" parent is no protection against a frightening world. The "submitting Christian" also accepts his parent's doctrine unquestioningly because he cannot bear the thought that his parents may have been mistaken.

But how does this apply to the "rebellious Christian?" He finds his security in totally rejecting his parent's values, at least in this particular respect. He grows up with a sense of superiority. He considers his denial of Christ more evolved. Here again confusion exists. It is indeed "more evolved" to deny the false denials, but it is not more evolved to deny the truths along with it. In the consciousness of such a person, there exists a tremendous fear of finding out that perhaps, after all, his parents were right. In the childish consciousness it is always either/or. You know that. All images are based on the inability to differentiate truth from falsehood because it is always associated with a total right versus a total wrong. Being right means being good, acceptable, having the power to create a safe life, being deserving of happiness. Being wrong means being bad, unacceptable, having no power to create safety, and not deserving happiness. This applies to the self and, by

extension, to the parents. The "rebellious Christian" can deal with the possibility that his parents were totally wrong. He is then justified in denying all they stood for. On a very primitive, childish level, the threat the "rebellious Christian" experiences now, when Jesus Christ is being re-introduced in a more dynamic way, is simply this: "If my parents were right after all about the reality of Jesus Christ, then they must also be right about my sexual feelings being sinful, about my surge for individuality, autonomy, and self-expression being sinful. I never have the right to be angry and to express my energies in an aggressive way, for all aggression must be bad. I am also guilty and bad for having denied Christ and my parents in the past. This I cannot bear, so I must turn against these ideas."

The stronger the inner confusion about what is true and what is false in the parental traditions, the stronger the fear of finding out "I was wrong, therefore I am bad." Consequently the stronger the threat and the rebellion against the newest phase that seems to echo parental admonitions.

You can see clearly that the mechanism is very much the same as with all image formation -- and image dissolution. You can also see clearly here that the personal image is multiplied many times, for many similar cases and conditions exist. Thereby a mass image is being created. The mass image of the "Christian rebel" harbors underneath the possibility of the "Christian submitter," and vice versa. The "Christian rebel" fears that if he touches on, challenges, and dissolves his image, he will have to become the "Christian submitter." And the "Christian submitter" is of course equally afraid to touch upon his image, for that would seem to mean to become the "Christian rebel" who throws out the beautiful truth of Jesus Christ, along with the falsehoods. On this path we deal much more with the former. The latter exists only as an underlying threat and fear that can be dissolved when the bright light of truth is being shed into the soul substance that holds these images rigidly and fixedly. We shall later not only discuss the other aspects of all images (wrong conclusion, vicious circle, proving the wrong conclusion correct); we shall also show the process how to dissolve the image.

Before, however, let us now discuss the Jewish mass image. It must always start with a personal image that is multiplied often enough to create a collective image. So we shall start with the feeling of being threatened if there is indeed Jesus Christ as a manifestation of God. Similar to the "submitting Christian," the Jew who denies Christ feels immensely threatened about his parents being wrong. If they are wrong in this, such an all-important question about life, the world, God, how can they be trusted in anything? The ground seems to slip away from under the feet of the child/adult. This applies just as much to the person who outwardly rebels against his parents, disagrees with them on many issues, as it applies to those who are overtly in agreement with them about almost all important issues about life. So, on one level this is a personal/psychological issue in which the part of the soul that has not grown up cannot deal with parents being wrong in anything because then they must be wrong in everything.

Behind this personal/psychological level of reacting lies a whole world of history -- tradition in its true and in its distorted form. Let me try to go into this aspect to some degree, as much as is possible at this time and for the purpose under discussion. There was a time when the Jews were the only ones who worshiped the Creator as the one God and who were in touch with Him and attempted to follow His commandments and laws. This beautiful reality began to disintegrate when, as is inevitable in human nature, the lower self entered into the picture. It induced pride, arrogance,

superiority toward those who did not belong to the Jewish community and faith. The pagan was looked down on as inferior, the Jew saw himself as the aristocrat in the human family.

The reason that Jesus Christ was born as a Jew was obvious. Since He was a manifestation and incarnation of the true God, of the real divine reality, He could only manifest among those people who worshipped this God rather than gods which were often spirits of quite undeveloped realms, even evil spirits (but not exclusively). This tremendous gift was also a test. This, too, is always true. All gifts are tests, just as painful occurrences are tests. The test was whether Jesus was recognized as who He was. In order to do so, this would have meant to overcome personal pride, power drives, self-interest, and self-serving opportunism. If this would have happened, there never could have come a split. No such thing as Judaism versus Christianity could have come about. Christianity would simply have been an extension in development of Judaism whether a new name would have been found to indicate this true way or whether either of these two names would have been used in the spirit of combining and extending the truth of the past into the truth of eternal now.

As a collective situation, the test has failed. This is obvious. The fear of admitting this failure is as irrational and distorted as the individual's fear of accepting his imperfections and blindnesses are. You have learned on this path that doing so is one of the most important aspects of growth, of self-liberation, of purification, of self-esteem. The defense against admitting a possible wrong perpetuates this wrong many times and creates secondary guilts that are so much more severe and harder to eradicate. The longer and harder the resistance to truth, the more painful it is. The same holds true for collective processes and dynamics. The only way collective images can be dissolved and consciousness can be in truth is through a sufficient number of individuals who have the courage and commitment to truth to stand up for it.

The Jews in power felt threatened (unjustly so) by Jesus Christ. The threat only applied to where they wished to deny divine truth and divine guidance. Since the leaders prevailed on the majority, only a few courageous ones turned to Christ. The separation was enforced by those who refused to consider that He could indeed have been the promised Messiah because they did not wish to abdicate their negative self-serving power. Once this separation existed, more of the pagans turned to the new message and embraced it. Their heart was hungering for it so that, as time went on, more pagans than Jews turned to Christ. The pagan's attitude to the Jews was to a large degree responsive to the inferiority that was stamped on them by the people who were supposed to carry God's love and God's word. Thus mutual enmity came into existence.

In the consciousness of the Jew, the pagan and the Christian became one and the same. He considered both as inferior and as hostile toward the Jew. The hostility was often true, but instead of asking himself how he contributed and provoked it and taking responsibility for the situation and seeing it as a mutual creation (just as you have learned to do on this path), he abdicated any responsibility and made himself the victim of the pagan, i.e., Christian, even as he continued to look down on him and to reject him.

This old history is very relevant, for those who are born into families which continue this attitude, harbor this attitude in their own souls. They can use the existing influences as a challenge, and thus they can contribute to dissolve the mass image. Or they can choose to further perpetuate it and thus the Jewish karma.

When any of you work on any personal problem and you find yourself terrified because your friends and helpers confront you -- when you defend against even the possibility of that with which you are being confronted -- you react according to the same erroneous assumption that being wrong, having lower self attitudes, having made a mistake is unforgivable and unacceptable. Your terror is very simply that! Your belief is that you are no longer lovable if this or that negativity were indeed true. Only as you gain courage and therefore humility as well, do you jump into the apparent abyss of opening your mind, and only then can you find out that your assumption was false. In fact only when you fully admit your imperfection and human fallibility do you become a full-fledged human being; do you find your true and realistic value; do you find God's love for you that has always existed, but that you could not feel due to your fallacy. This has always been the true path, and this will always be the true path. It applies for collective situations just as much as for individual ones.

It must become increasingly obvious to the observer that the same dynamics hold true in mass images as in individual images. The more truth is being denied, the greater the real guilt becomes, therefore the greater the resistance in order to ward off accumulated guilt. Negative karma is an accumulation over several life times of unresolved, untruthful situations that have their own laws and consequences, just as truth has its laws and consequences. When these consequences are persistently interpreted as happenings out of context, thereby making a victim out of the Jewish race, the vitality you need is taken away from you by you -- the vitality to be a self-governing part in the human family. You can only become this autonomous person if truth stands above defense -- when truth is being more important than justifying yourself, or your parents, or your forefathers. The constant chain of cause and effect, of negative karma, of endless repetition of undesirable events can be broken, my friends. Why can you see these dynamics so clearly when it comes to personal aspects at this time, and yet you draw the line when it comes to the collective reality?

The answer is -- above and beyond what I said before about the terror of the child that parents can be wrong -- that the personal guilt in denying the truth of Jesus Christ just seems too painful to bear. It would entail giving up the victim and blame game. It would entail assuming part responsibility for much of the past suffering. It would entail experiencing the pain of guilt for having inflicted pain, especially on one who came in love. You may or may not have actually lived at that time. But even if you had not been present, by allying yourself with those who were directly responsible, by justifying their actions, and by not ever asking the crucial question, "Could it be that He was the promised Messiah?" you do become coresponsible.

When you work on any personal issue where you, after much resistance, finally dedicate your being to wanting to see the truth, you sometimes go indeed through the pain of guilt. But when you do this in a spirit of life rather than death, in a spirit of faith rather than denial, you come to self-acceptance, self-forgiveness, and therefore you experience that God has already forgiven you all along. You then experience the light and new strength of wholeness. Feeling the pain of real guilt is never a debilitating process. It is a life process, it is purification, and it leads to oneness with yourself, with others, with God. Can you find it within yourself to attempt this same attitude with whatever universal issue that comes up in your life? What do you have to fear if truth (God) is your major concern? By refusing this openness, you express in no uncertain terms that truth is not the major issue for you, but being right is. No matter how you try to justify your antagonism against Jesus Christ, you are not in truth when you refuse to pose this question in a sincere and open way

and then allow for a period of gestation for the answer to evolve within your own mind and heart. How can you believe yourself to be free and liberated when anything within you is closed up tight, when justifying your forefather's infallible rightness on this central question is more important than the truth itself?

Just observe the feeling of threat in you when these words are being addressed to you. Consider the meaning of this reaction. Can you perhaps distance yourself from it for a moment and then consider that this feeling may be a distortion, may be irrational, may contain false assumptions on your part? This in itself is a healing you administer to yourself.

Let us now consider the dynamics of images as I have taught you and as you have worked on your path in many personal issues where images destroy your life. A brief recapitulation here is in order. An image is a false idea, a wrong conclusion formed in childhood with insufficient mental equipment to make a correct assessment. This wrong conclusion, as all untruth, creates negative situations, feelings, and events. Untruth is always painful. The defense against the wrong conclusion creates a negative action and reaction pattern which effects others adversely. The misconception is fixed and frozen in the soul substance because it is never questioned or challenged. The personality reacts blindly in a conditioned reflex rather than out of truth appropriate to the particular occasion. The negative effect created in others must perforce come back to the individual and always appears to confirm the original misconception, which seems to necessitate the defense, which creates negative reactions in others. And so it goes on endlessly. The soul is not free when any image exists.

The image of the "rebellious Christian" is "If I embrace Christ, I must give up my vitality, my energy life, my sexuality, my body, pleasure, for all these are sinful." Therefore he creates a defense that shuts out Christ in order to affirm his sexuality. But shutting out Christ means shutting out an essential part of God's world of truth, love, beauty, and life. A split comes into existence in which the individual lives in pain, hidden doubt, and guilt. Instead of liberating his forces, he must be defiant about them. And you all know that defiance is nothing but an ill-advised attempt to shut out other voices within. Therefore instead of becoming stronger, he becomes weaker. He may cover up this weakness by a masked strength which often deceives no one, least of all himself. He feels a failure and a fraud and does not know why. In fact he believes his weakness stems from having been influenced in his childhood to accept Jesus Christ and that he was not sufficiently successful in rejecting Him. The more you reject a truth, any truth, the more you weaken yourself in some way. The more split off you become. The more conflict arises. So the misconception that Christ meant you to deny your vital juices of life creates attitudes and reactions in you that, in the end, seem to bear out the original misconception.

The Jewish mass image is: "If my parents and forefathers have been wrong and killed not only a good man but a man who manifested God on earth, they are totally bad people. They can never be forgiven. I cannot face this possibility. I must deny this possibility in order not to be coresponsible with them." But did not Christ tell, again and again, that God is forgiveness? Is He not always here with His mercy, understanding, and love? Is this not one of the great messages He brought -- that God does not punish mercilessly and unforgivingly, that it is never "an eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth?" Here we have a vicious circle: by believing totally in the old tradition of Judaism, "an eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth" makes admitting a sin impossible. The

punishment is too terrible. Therefore the truth, even the possibility that Jesus Christ may be the truth, must be denied.

Now how does this image work? The misconception is that Jesus was a false prophet; that He was a fake; that the pagans (and Christians) are lying, are deluded, are inferior, and at the same time the victimizers, out to annihilate the Jews. The more firmly this belief was held, the more hatred and discrimination, the more separation and enmity grew in the many individual Jewish consciousnesses, thereby creating a mass image. The defense against this belief had to create more antagonism and actual persecution of the Jew. So the misconception created a defense which in turn could not help but bear out the apparent truth of the misconception.

The greater the guilt and therefore the fear of its pain and its supposed unforgivability, the stronger must be the defense against the truth in question, pertaining to the issue. The more the heart and mind must remain closed, and the more this fact must be denied, justified, and fought against.

My beloved friends, for so many years you have been working on your psyche, on your soul substance. You have dealt with many an image in your personal psyche. You have come to see the damage of all images, for images are not only distortion of truth, misconceptions, and misperceptions. They therefore inevitably create a stiff soul substance that walls you off from the best within yourself; from life with all its creative possibilities; from God; from loving and from being able to receive and accept love. Images, in their untruth, are evil and create sin. They create war within the soul, war in the personality and outside with others. You have learned, often painstakingly, the importance of challenging and dissolving your images. There is only one way to do this. It is to start asking very probing questions. This brings a new light into the picture. It opens doors that were heretofore closed. It loosens up hardened soul substance. In order to dissolve any image, many questions need to be asked from all possible angles. The mind must be open to look at the situation and to consider everything that may be relevant to the issue.

In the last lecture, I spoke about tradition in its positive and negative connotations. I also spoke about certain movements of this path, its emphases at various periods and phases. In the last year or so, it must have become quite obvious to many of you, who occasionally observe the direction this path takes, that from the emphasis on individual purification and self-liberation through dissolution of false images, we are increasingly concerned with creating a new society. This includes dissolving whatever mass images stand in the way to the unfoldment of the self-realized person. The new society, of which you are pioneers, cannot afford to live with frozen images in the soul substance.

I have often said that this path represents the new age person. It is no coincidence that a mixture of religious backgrounds is so prevalent here. For example, in your political committees you learn how politics could be run with the principles you are learning. In the running of your business, of your administration, you learn in practical application the same thing. In your artistic pursuits, you approach your creative processes in an entirely new way in order to release your blocks. Why then would this be different about religious affiliation and beliefs? In order to dissolve these particular mass images, it is necessary to see that there are images to investigate, to question, to challenge, and to have new considerations on the subject rather than simply letting it be, without touching the subjects that directly effect these images.

The new age society knows no Judaism nor Christianity as it is known now. Yet it knows both. It takes the truth from both and expands upon it as it can filter through the newly evolving and expanding consciousness. This new age person is so free that no word can trigger off emotional reactions, whether this word be "Jew" or "Christian," "Jesus Christ" or "religion." For many, the word "reincarnation" has a similar connotation. It is against the teachings of both Judaism and Christianity, at least as in the form taught today. Yet it is one of the eternal truths regardless of whether it fits into the religion embraced by certain individuals. Does it not strike you as peculiarly significant that this word and also the concept behind the word fails to elicit similarly strong reactions as does the word "Jesus Christ?" You may or may not believe in reincarnation, to begin with, but there is no strong emotional involvement with, nor a stake in, denying this idea. This is why your doors are much more open in this regard and sooner or later you experience inwardly, within yourself, the truth of reincarnation.

The new man and the new woman are free from emotional involvements that block truth. There is no stake in holding on to anything or in denying anything. They accept what is truth. This commitment is firm and is always expressed toward the Creator. Thus truth can flow freely. The new age person is not bound to nationality, political party, race, or creed. He combines all their truths and rejects all their errors just as I explained in the lecture about new age politics in which democracy, communism, socialism, monarchy, and capitalism are all combined in their truths in the best sense and thus leave out the untruths, which create separation and setting one against the other. The same applies to any other human expression. In religion too, the truth combines and unifies; untruth separates. Untruth and separation create evil, dissension, hostility, outer and inner warfare, mutually exclusive dualities: "If I am a Jew, I cannot be a Christian, I cannot believe in reincarnation. If I believe in monarchy, I cannot see the good in some socialistic and/or communistic ideas. If I am progressive, I cannot be for tradition." All these are false choices that separate. When you are one versus the other, you are the one thing with a vengeance, thus you cannot be it in its best sense.

In the current turmoil about Jesus Christ, those who are burdened with their own fear and mass images in this regard often do not hold their own best traditions in their heart. They often pride themselves to be not at all religiously inclined. So, their violent reactions against the possibility of Christ's existence, when truly analyzed, turns out to be a prideful stubbornness, a false sense of individuality.

Genuine individuality can never be associated with any group consciousness, religion, nationality, political party. True individuality blossoms only when God's truth is sought in all issues, at all times so that personal inner experience can flower. Individuals in that real sense will create the new group consciousness that is made up of free men and women for whom God's will reigns first and above all else. In this kind of group, the group is never in opposition to the individual, but, as I mentioned before, the one furthers the other.

Your earth suffers deeply from human beings who have not yet understood this truth -- who are still too immature to grasp the immense strength, autonomy, and freedom that lie in giving over totally to God while working constantly on cleansing the psyche of impurities, ignorance, confusion, false images, emotional tightnesses, and displacement of individuality into any kind of societal traditionalism. The suffering in your world is exclusively caused by these attitudes that are often confused with dignity, pride in the desirable sense, character, self-value, etc. Look at warring

countries that cannot come to a peace agreement. Each is steeped in its own rightness, while the other is wrong. Neither can see, or wants to see, the rightness and wrongness in both. It is very obvious with this example, but the same ill exists in much subtler issues that do not seem immediately connected with the world's dissension and suffering.

Humanity is beginning to grow up. The process is slow and often hindered by personal resistance to growth; habitual ways of thinking whose pattern is never questioned; rigidified ideas that people refuse to let go of; personal laziness; and, last but not least, the tragic error that the old ways are safe and must therefore be worshipped and held on to. It is through these attitudes that the forces of evil have access to the human consciousness and plunge it into destructiveness which manifests in various ways. The whole process of growing up is hindered, delayed, with unnecessary suffering created along the way. You are familiar with these dynamics in your individual paths. Humanity as a whole goes through these identical dynamics. The more human beings can remove their own blocks and cleanse their own souls and psychic substance, the more humanity as a whole will become ready. Just like you as an individual contain a part in which you want to give your best to your own evolution and overcome resistances and fear, and contain a part that seeks reasons to stop this process, humanity as a whole contains these two parts. Those individuals who follow their true destiny are humanity's higher self; those who resist it are humanity's lower self. Just like in your individual struggle, it is all a question of which part is the stronger; so humanity goes through the same shift of balances.

It is not true that there must always be war, suffering, injustice on this earth. This only holds true as long the majority of human beings refuse to grow up and remain in a state of inner error, falsehood, and confusion. The stronger people like you become in your purpose, in your understanding in what is involved here, the more individuals will give up their personal pride, self-interest, small opportunism (which all amounts to lack of faith), the more you and those like you will shift the balance. Mankind will begin to grow into its innate destiny.

But how is faith to grow? Only when the will to know God and His will are applied to all issues, can God manifest to you and will faith become, not an empty word, but a realistic experience. As you have the duty toward yourself to liberate yourself from all personal images because they hinder and frustrate your scope of aliveness and ability to experience love, truth, and beauty, so do you have an obligation toward your own human race to free itself from all mass images by eliminating your own mass images. You and your life is at stake, but also so much more!

Perhaps you can begin to visualize the new age person, the new society in a way you have never done before. See this new you in a joyous, extremely free way. See a society in which dissension and separation have no longer any room because when they do come up, they are being treated on the deeper levels, as you learn to do individually. You have learned on this path that when there is enmity between you and another person, it can always be resolved when you truly wish to be in truth and when you go on the deeper levels beneath the surface. See this new society that you are in the process of building and that will be, as I often said before, a model for the whole world.

The unity I am talking about has nothing to do with "tolerance." To tolerate implies that there is still a difference, a difference that you might feel superior over or not, but surely a difference. There are three stages in this respect in mankind's evolution regarding unity versus

separation: (1) separation in outright enmity; (2) tolerance; (3) union, unity, oneness. To find this oneness underneath the diversity means peace, means love, means truth, means growing into a mature humanity.

Applying this to the topic of Jesus Christ, mankind has outgrown the stage of killing each other for being a Jew or for being a Christian. Now when I say this, I mean that when this still happens, it is considered a horrible crime by the majority of mankind rather than being condoned. Mankind's most prevalent attitude today, at least on the surface, is for the Jew to tolerate the Christian, and vice versa. Underneath the surface, find those areas where you can admit that you wish to annihilate the other for being "different" and thus challenging your insecurity about your spirituality and your religious background. Some of you have already done this and have thus traversed a tunnel in which you could find the next stage you are intrinsically ready for: oneness, unity. The differences are wiped out, you find Jesus was never a dividing force. Jews and Christians, in their distortions, have created this impression. Jesus Christ happened as a bridge, as a further stage of love and truth that applies to all of mankind and unifies all of mankind. So tolerance has no longer any room in this new unity. You are all one in all the great traditions that ever reached the earth and that contain aspects of truth. Combined, they tell more of the whole story: the story of creation, the story of humanity, the story of man's relationship to God, the story of God's presence in man's life.

Wipe out the superficial differences and find the great bond of inner oneness -- not by eliminating Him, who has turned into a controversial figure, but by eliminating the artificial, erroneous controversy that is totally based on human limitation of vision and misunderstanding. If the Jew feels put aside because of Christ, try to see that having sent Christ into a Jewish incarnation was God's great act of love for His Jewish children. If the Christian feels that he must deny his energies, his pleasure principle if he embraces Christ, try to see that this is merely a wrong interpretation. Wipe out your misunderstandings, challenge your assumptions, consider that truth may be totally different -- different in such a way that not only do you lose nothing, but you gain everything, all that you ever fear of losing when you give up your fixed ideas.

The new light nourishes and strengthens you, all of you. It accelerates its force and impact as your souls become freer, more open, more questioning in a spirit of truth-searching, more filled with good will toward God's gifts of love for you. The universe extends its tender love to each one of you, as individuals and as a new group of humans on whom the spirit world sets so much hope. You are all blessed!

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